Project: The other Akkadian flood versions → Hebrew

▼ Contents

Scope 1
Base text and sources 3
Numbering 3
Decisions 4
Progress log 4
Parallels index 5
Synoptic table of the key motifs 11
A. Before the flood 12
B. The flood and after 15
Proposals for the shared renderings 18
Lessons for the guidelines 19

Read `../../translation-guidelines.md` first, then `../corpus.md` and the shared `../renderings.md`. This file holds only what is specific to this project.

Scope

Every Akkadian flood text **other than** the OB Sippar Atra-ḫasīs III (project 1) and Gilgameš XI (project 2), each translated in full as a text of its own, one section per manuscript (= per recension):

§	Siglum (Wasserman 2020)	Tablet	Date, place	Content
1	**Ark**	Ark Tablet (Simmonds coll.; cast BM)	late OB or early MB (c. 1750–1600 BCE?), unknown provenance	Ea's address to the wall; building instructions for a **round** rope boat (coracle); ribs, stanchions, cabins; bitumen inside and out; loading; the hero's anxiety; **animals "two by two"**; provisions; "seal her door". 60 lines, first person after l. 12.
2	**C_0**	Schøyen MS 5108 (CUSAS 10, 2), col. iv	early OB, Larsa area?	The gods' decision; Atra-ḫasīs kneels and weeps before Ea; Ea's answer. iv 1′–19′. (iv 1′–7′ are also in Atr. II's appendix: identical Hebrew.)
3	**J**	CBS 13532 (Nippur)	MB	Ea's instructions: a reed boat named "Life-Keeper", a strong roof, beasts and birds, family.
4a	**I**	RS 22.421 (Ugarit)	MB	Prologue: "When the gods took counsel …"; Atra-ḫasīs the priest speaks in the **first person**; Ea and the reed wall; rev.: eternal life; colophon of Nuʿme-Rašap.
4b	**I_1**	RS 20.161+20.171B (Ugarit)	MB	A pupil's draft; possibly the storm (doubtful).
4c	**I_2**	RS 94.2953 (Ugarit)	MB	First person: new moon; Ea says "make a window at the top"; dove released, returns exhausted; a crane (*kumû*).
5	**J_1**	KBo 36, 26 (Ḫattuša)	MB	Atra-ḫasīs and the elders; Ea's speech; "kilns".
6	MB Babylon	MM 818 (eBL "MB Bab_2"), VAT 17099, etc.	MB	**Tablets I–II, not the flood.** Noted, not re-translated (see below).
7a	**W**	DT 42 (Nineveh)	NA (SB text)	Ea's instructions (round boat, roof, sealing, the appointed time, cargo, animals sent by Ea); "I never built a boat": Ea draws the plan on the ground.

§	Siglum (Wasserman 2020)	Tablet	Date, place	Content
7b	**BM 38917** (eBL Fragmentarium, not in Wasserman 2020)	Babylon?	LB	Duplicate of W 11′–16′ plus new lines; rev.: "to six, to seven, to eight" (decks), "Life-Keeper is her name", cargo.
7c	**U**	BM 98977+99231 (Nineveh)	NA, "Assyrian recension"	Atra-ḫasīs hears Ea's footsteps; Ea speaks to the reed fence; the storm: the four winds as Adad's mules; Ninurta, Errakal, Anzû; the gods in fear.
7d	**z**	MMA 86.11.378A	LB / Achaemenid	Rev. col. v: Ea's rebuke of Enlil ("instead of a flood …"), "let no flood be brought about from this day"; Enlil takes the hero out of the boat, **renames him** (Zisudra → Ūt-napištim), blesses him and his wife.

Out of scope: Atra-ḫasīs OB I–III (project 1); Gilgameš XI (project 2); mss R (K 4539) and W_1 (Sm. 365), which Wasserman 2020 excludes as not proven to belong to the flood; z obverse (Enlil's plague; edited by Lambert 2005, not in Wasserman, not available here).

Base text and sources

- **Base (rank 1):** Wasserman 2020 (OBO 290), §2.2.1 (C_0) and §2.3.1–2.3.9 (pp. 60–103), = SEAL nodes 1518, 1520, 1559, 1561, 1562, 27122, 27124, 27127, 27128, 27129 (identical text, with per-word lemmas). `../../sources/Wasserman-2020--The-Flood-Akkadian-Sources/...text.md`, `../../sources/SEAL/`.
- **eBL corpus** (`../../sources/eBL/`): "MB Priv" = the Ark Tablet (MOW 1), ll. 1–11 only, with notes (George 2016, Streck 2017, Finkel 2014); "MB Ug_2" = I_2, with the NABU 2008/70 collation (I_2 2 *ina šuttīya* "in my dream" for Wasserman's *ina aḫiya*); "MB Bab_2" = MM 818 (Tablet I).
- **eBL Fragmentarium** (`../../sources/eBL-fragmentarium/atf/`): DT.42, CBS.13532 (Pickworth's collations), **BM.38917** (new duplicate of W), BM.41330 (Tablet I), BM.42004, UM.55-21-29 (not flood).
- Older: Hilprecht 1910 (J), Met Museum photos (z), Schøyen catalogue (C_0); historical only.
- **Comparison (rank 3, read after drafting):** Wasserman 2020 / SEAL translations; Finkel 2014 and George 2016 as quoted by Wasserman and eBL; eBL translations (Ark 1–11, I_2).

Numbering

Wasserman 2020 / SEAL: siglum + (side) + line, primes as in the edition: `Ark 12`, `C₀ iv 8′`, `J r. 5′`, `I 6`, `I r. 4′`, `I₁ B 5′`, `I₂ 11`, `J₁ 4′`, `W 9′`, `U 14`, `U r. 7′`, `z v 17′`. BM 38917 follows eBL: `BM 38917 obv. 4′`, `rev. 12′`. Line breaks are the tablet's, even where (I_2, Ugarit) they cut a sentence awkwardly.

Decisions

1. **One section per manuscript**, each with a short Hebrew introduction. In the clean translation each section is a text of its own.
2. **Shared lines.** Where the Akkadian is identical to Gilg. XI or Atra-ḫasīs (OB I–III, C_0 iv 1′–7′ in Atr. II's appendix), the Hebrew is identical; where it differs, it differs exactly there. Marked `[מקבילה: …]`.
3. **Echo control decisions specific to these texts** (details in `renderings.md`):
   - Ark 18–19 *kīdātiša / qiribša* → `לְחוּצוֹתֶיהָ / לְקִרְבָּהּ`: "outside" is the only natural Hebrew word for *kīdu* [equivalent with `מְחוּץ`]; *qerbu* / `קֶרֶב` is a real cognate, so `מִבַּיִת` is **not** borrowed.
   - Ark 52 *šanā* → `שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם`: *šanā* is the distributive of *šina* "two", cognate of `שְׁנַיִם`; Hebrew expresses the distributive by repetition. Real [cognate], not a borrowed echo. Reading uncertain (`⌈ša⌉-na`), marked.
   - Ark 51 *nammaštû* → `הַנָּע (בַּשָּׂדֶה)`, not `רָמַשׂ`: "what moves" is the etymological sense (*namāšu* "move"); `רָמַשׂ` would pre-empt the comparison. The parallel with `הָרָמַשׂ` is noted [equivalent].
   - J r. 9′ / W 3′ *ṣulūlu*, *ṣullulu* → `קֹרָה` , `קוֹרָה` (Gilg. XI 31 `קֹרָה`): roofing, not sealing.
   - *naṣāru* → `נָצַר` [cognate] (Atr. II); J r. 8′ *nāṣirat napištim* → `נוֹצֶרֶת נָפֶשׁ` (the boat's name; cf. משלי `וְנֹצֵר נַפְשְׁךָ` , יב:כד).
   - *eṣēru / uṣurtu / eṣertu* → `צָר / צוּרָה` (Atr. I's choice: cognate of יצר; cf. יחזקאל מג:יא , `צוּרַת הַבַּיִת`). Gilg. XI 60 used `שִׂרְטֵט`; changed to `צַרְתִּי` in the harmonization pass.
   - W 6′ *bāba turru* "close the door" → `הָגֵף`, not (ז:טז , `וַיִּסְגֹּר`) `סָגֹר`: the parallel is noted [divergence/equivalent].
   - I_2 1 *rēš arḫi* → `רֹאשׁ הַיָּרֵחַ` (*warḫu* = ירח [cognate], as Atr. II `יוֹם הַיָּרֵחַ`), not `רֹאשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ`.
   - z v 18′ *tādirti libbi* → `קַדְּרוּת לֵב` (*adāru* "be dark" = קדר), not `עִצָּבוֹן` (which would echo ה:כט; ו:ו).
   - z v 4′–8′ *kūm* → `בִּמְקוֹם אֲשֶׁר`, distinct from Gilg. XI *ammaku* `תַּחַת אֲשֶׁר`.
4. **Numbers.** *šār* (ŠÁR) = `שָׁאר` (3,600; shared with Gilg. XI). *šūši* "sixty" is rendered by its value (1 *šūši* = ,שישים 5 *šūši* = שלוש מאות), with the notation in the apparatus. Units supplied by Wasserman are in ( ): (כּוֹר), (קוּ).
5. **Names.** Sîn (Ark 45) = `סִין`; Nuʿme-Rašap (I r. 5′) = `נָעֲמֵי־רַשַׁף`; Antu = `אַנְתִּוּ`; Ninlil = `נִינְלִיל`; Anzû = `אַנְזוּ`; Zisudra (z v 17′) = shared `זִיּוּסוּדְרָה` (spelling noted); *Ut-napištim* = shared `אוּתְנַפְשְׁתִּי` (z's mimated form is the source of the common `אותנפישתים`: noted).
6. **I_2 2:** translated with Wasserman (*ina aḫiya* "at my side"); the eBL / NABU 2008/70 collation *ina šuttīya* "in my dream" is given in a footnote, since it changes the "warning" column of the synopsis.
7. **MB Babylon (§6):** MM 818 (= eBL MB Bab_2) parallels Atra-ḫasīs OB I 38–67 and is already translated, line by line, in `../אתרחסיס-1/` (Tablet I, ll. 51–56 filled from it). VAT 17099 (SEAL 1560, Tablet II) and SEAL 27123/27126 have no text in SEAL. They are listed in the annotated file, not re-translated.

Progress log

- 2026-10-16: sources read (Wasserman 2020 pp. 14–19, 39–41, 60–103; SEAL 1518, 1520, 1559, 1561, 1562, 27122–27129, 1517; eBL MB Priv / Ug_2 / Bab_2; eBL Fragmentarium ATFs). Sibling projects read: Gilg. XI (translation, renderings, shared-lines table), Atr. II appendix (C_0 iv 1′–7′), Berossus, Sumerian Flood Story. Atr. III: not yet begun by its translator at start; to re-check at the end.
- 2026-10-16: project.md created; `renderings.md` written before drafting.
- 2026-10-16: drafted `annotated.rtl.md`: §1 Ark 1–60; §2 C_0 iv 1′–19′; §3 J 1′–12′, r. 1′–14′; §4 I 1–15, r. 1′–6′; I_1 B 1′–13′; I_2 1–14; §5 J_1 1′–13′; §6 (note only); §7 W 1′–17′, BM 38917 obv. 1′–20′ / rev. 1′–16′, U 1–20 / r. 1′–25′, z v 1′–27′; §8 (fragments checked and excluded). 274 numbered entries.
- 2026-10-16: Atra-ḫasīs III (`../אתרחסיס/annotated-III.rtl.md`) appeared during drafting; all shared lines re-synced with it (Ark 4, 38, 51; C_0 iv 8′–19′, which that file also translates; W 3′; U r. 7′, 17′, 23′; I_1 B 6′; notes quoting its Hebrew). Gilg. XI shared lines checked against its `translation.rtl.md`.

- 2026-10-16: `translation.rtl.md` generated from the annotated file (script in the session scratchpad, `p4/build_translation.py`): Hebrew introduction, an introduction per manuscript, 20 internal headings, 21 footnotes.
- Review passes: (a) fidelity – every line re-read against Wasserman/SEAL and the eBL ATF; brackets follow the edition; (b) consistency – shared lines and formulas compared with Gilg. XI and Atr. II/III by script (exact strings); repeated lines (U 1–2 = 5–6 = 7–8; Ark 33/58; W ↔ BM 38917) identical; (c) Hebrew – unvocalized except names at first occurrence and ambiguous words. All Bible quotations checked with `tools/check_bible_quotes.py` (0 problems).

Parallels index

Tags per guidelines §6.4. Genesis references are to chapter:verse.

Line	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	Comment
Ark 1; I 12–14; U 14–16	*igār igār kikkiš kikkiš*	קיר, קיר! גדר־קנה, גדר־קנה!	6:13	[absent]	The god speaks to a wall, not to the man.
Ark 3	*taballuṭ dāriš*	ותחיה לָעַד	3:22	[equivalent]	Eternal life promised at the outset (cf. I r. 4′, z v 19′).
Ark 4; J r. 6′	*bini eleppam*	בנה ספינה	6:14	[divergence]	*eleppu* = ordinary "boat"; no wood named; Ark: rope; J: reeds; I₂: wood (axe).
Ark 5	*napištam šullim*	ושמור נפש שלמה	6:19–20 לְהַחֲיֹת	[cognate] נפש, שלם / [equivalent]	
Ark 6; J r. 10′	*eleppam teppušu*	הספינה אשר תעשה	6:15 וְזֶה אֲשֶׁר תַּעֲשֶׂה אֹתָהּ	[equivalent]	Same verb (*epēšu* = עשה) and construction, opening the dimensions.
Ark 6–7; W 14′–16′	*eṣēru*, *eṣertu kippatim*	אצור ... צורת עיגול; צור צורה	6:15; cf. Exod 25:9	[divergence]	The god draws the plan himself.
Ark 7; W 2′	*kippatu*	עיגול	6:15	[divergence]	**Round boat** vs. 300×50 cubits.
Ark 8	*lū mitḫar šiddaša u pussa*	יהיו שווים צדה ומצחה	6:15 אָרְכָּהּ רָחְבָּהּ ...	[equivalent]/[divergence]	Length = width.
Ark 9	1 *ikû* base, 1 *nindanu* walls	איקו אחד – קרקעה, קנה אחד – קירותיה	6:15 וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אַמָּה קוֹמָתָהּ	[divergence]	c. 3,600 m², c. 6 m high.
Ark 13	*ṣēlī*	צלעות	—	[cognate] צלע	Ribs of the coracle.
Ark 15–17	*imdū*, *ḫinnū elēnum u šaplum*	תמוכות; תאיה למעלה ולמטה	6:14 קִנִּים; 6:16 תַּחְתִּים שְׁנִיִּם וּשְׁלִשִׁים	[equivalent]/[divergence]	Two decks; cabins (*ḫinnu* is not *qinnu*).

Line	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	Comment
Ark 18–19	***iṭṭâm kīdātiša … iṭṭâm qiribša***	**חמר … לחוצותיה חמר לקרבה**	**6:14 מִבַּ֫יִת וּמִחוּץ**	**[equivalent]**; *qerbu*/קרב [cognate]	**The only Mesopotamian parallel to "inside and out".**
Ark 21, 31–32	*kupru*	כֹּ֫פֶר	6:14 בַּכֹּ֫פֶר	[cognate]	Melted in kilns; *kīdû* "outside" (32).
Ark 18–24	*iṭṭû*	חֵמָר	11:3; 14:10; Exod 2:3	[equivalent]	Crude bitumen.
Ark 35, 59; W 6′; U r. 3′	*erēbu* (*ana eleppi*)	בא (אל הספינה)	7:1, 7	[equivalent]	"Enter" (Gilg. XI 85 has "go up").
Ark 35–37; W 8′; J r. 13′	kith and kin, in-laws, pregnant women, craftsmen	משפחה וקרובים, מחותנים, הרות, בני האומנים	6:18; 7:7	[divergence]	Genesis: eight persons.
Ark 38	*ākilum ikkal šātûm išatti*	האוכל – אוכל, [השותה] – שותה	—	[absent]	= Atr. III ii 43–44.
Ark 39–45	the hero's anxiety; prayer to Sîn	דבר היה בלבי … התפללתי אל סין	6:22	[absent]	Noah is silent and obedient.
Ark 49; C_o iv 2′	*gamertu*	כָּלָה	6:13 קֵ֣ץ כָּל בָּשָׂר	[equivalent]	Enlil swears (Ark).
Ark 50; C_o iv 6′; I_2 1	the dark day / *ūm warḫim* / *rēš arḫi*	ביום החשוך / יום הירח / ראש הירח	7:11; 8:5, 13	[divergence]; *warḫu*/ירח [cognate]	Dated by the moon's disappearance. In I_2 the date marks the **end** (the window).
Ark 51	*nammaštum [ina ṣē]rim*	וְהַנָּע ב[ש]דה	6:20; 7:14	[equivalent]	Not cognate (see Proposals).

Line	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	Comment
Ark 52	***šanā eleppa***	**שנים שנים – (אל) הספינה**	**7:9, 15 שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם**	**[cognate]**	**Only Mesopotamian "two by two"**; reading uncertain. No clean/unclean, no male and female.
Ark 53–57	beer, fodder, plants, lard	שכר, מספוא …	6:21	[equivalent]; *šikaru*/שכר [cognate]	Provisions.
Ark 60	*piḫi pīt bābiša*	סתום את מִפְתַּח פתחה	7:16 וַיִּסְגֹּר יְהוָה בַּעֲדוֹ	[divergence]	The hero has the door sealed; in Genesis God shuts it.
C_0 iv 1′	*ay išmeā*	אל ישמעו (האנשים)	6:13	[divergence]	The decree is hidden from man.
C_0 iv 3′–4′	*šipram lemnam … Enlil*	… מעשה רע אנליל	6:5	[divergence]	The "evil" is the god's flood, not man's heart.
C_0 iv 13′–15′	*ana nišī tabakki … ādirī attā*	על האנשים … אתה בוכה הפוחד מפניי אתה –	6:8–9; 7:1; 22:12	[absent]/[divergence]	The hero weeps for mankind; chosen for reverence, not righteousness.
J r. 2′	*apaššar*	אפתור	40:8; 41:15	[cognate] פתר/פשר	Hint of a dream (Wasserman).
J r. 4′; U r. 18′	*abūbu waṣû*	צאת המבול / יצא המבול	7:6	[cognate] יצא	
J r. 7′	*ina qanê ṭābi … binûssa*	מקנה טוב יהי מבנה	6:14 עֲצֵי גֹפֶר; Exod 2:3 תֵּבַת גֹּמֶא	[divergence]	Reed boat.
J r. 8′; BM 38917 rev. 12′	*nāṣirat napištim*	נוצרת נפש	6:19–20; 7:3	[cognate] נצר, נפש / [absent]	The boat has a name.
J r. 9′; W 3′	*ṣulūla danna ṣullil*	קורה חזקה – קרה	6:16; 8:13 מִכְסֵה הַתֵּבָה	[equivalent]	A roof, not sealing.

Line	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	Comment
J r. 11′	***[būl ṣē]rim umām ṣērim iṣṣur šamê***	**[בהמת]ה, חיית השד, ציפור השדה, ציפור השמים**	**7:3, 8, 14; 6:20**	**[equivalent]**; *iṣṣūru*/צפור, *šamû*/שמים [cognate]	Genesis's three groups (beast, cattle, bird of heaven).
J r. 12′	*kummir*	צבור	6:21 וְאָסַפְתָּ אֵלֶיךָ	[equivalent]	
I 1–2	*ilū imtalkū milka … abūba iškunū*	האלים נמלכו עצה … מבול חוללו	6:7, 17	[divergence]	Divine council vs. one God.
I 6	*pašīšu*	המשוח	8:20	[absent]	The hero is a priest; first-person narration.
I r. 4′; z v 19′	*kī ilī balāṭa*	כאלים – חיים	3:22; 9:29	[divergence]	Immortality vs. Noah's death.
I_2 2	*ina aḫiya* (eBL: *ina šuttīya*)	לצידי (בחלומי?)	6:13	[divergence]	If "in my dream": cf. Gilg. XI 197, Berossus.
I_2 3–4, 9	*marru u ḫaṣṣinnu*	מעדר וגרזן נחושת	6:14 עֲצֵי גֹפֶר	[divergence]	A wooden boat (Wasserman).
I_2 4–5, 10	***apta ēpuš ana muḪḪiya***	**חלון עשיתי מעל ראשי**	**8:6 חַלּוֹן הַתֵּבָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה; 6:16**	**[equivalent]**	Window made, then a bird sent: the same sequence as 8:6–8. Made at the end, not before.
I_2 6	*iṣṣūram-ma līmurakka kibra*	ציפור – ותראה לך קצה (של יבשה)	8:8 לִרְאוֹת הֲקַלּוּ הַמָּיִם	[equivalent]; *iṣṣūru*/צפור [cognate]	The god orders the bird; in Genesis Noah decides.
I_2 11–13	*summata umaššir illik itūram-ma ušāniḫi kappīša*	יונה … שילחתי; הלכה וחזרה, עייפה את כנפיה	8:8–9	[equivalent]	Dove first; returns because she found no rest.
I_2 14	*ašnī-ma … kumâ umaššir*	שניתי … ועגור(?) שילחתי	8:10, 12	[equivalent]/[divergence]	*šanû*/שנה [cognate]; a water bird, not a raven.
W 5′	*adanna ša ašapparakka*	המועד אשר אשלח אליך	7:4	[equivalent]	God announces the date.

Line	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	Comment
W 6′	*eleppa ērum-ma bāb eleppi tirra*	בוא, והגף את פתח הספינה	7:1, 16	[equivalent]/[divergence]	God orders the hero to shut the door.
W 7′	*uṭṭatka bušâka u makkūrka*	דגנך, נכסיך ורכושך	6:21	[equivalent]/[absent]	Property goes aboard (vs. "spurn property", Atr. III i 23).
W 9′	*mala urqītu mer ʾīšun*	כל אשר ירק מרעיתם	1:30; 9:3 יֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב	[cognate] ירק	Herbivores only.
W 10′	***ašapparakkum-ma inaṣṣarū bābka***	**אשלח אליך, וינצרו את פתחך**	**6:20 יָבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ; 7:9, 15**	**[equivalent]**	**The god sends the animals to the hero**: only here in Akkadian.
W 13′	*matīma eleppa ul ēpuš*	מעולם ספינה לא עשיתי	6:22	[absent]	
BM 38917 rev. 7′–9′	*ana šeššīšu / sebêšu / samānîšu*	לשישה, לשבעה, לשמונה	6:16	[divergence]	Cf. Gilg. XI 61–63 (6, 7, 9).
U r. 5′	*Adad … irtakab parêšu*	אדד … רכב – פרדיו	8:1; Ps 18:11; 104:3	[absent]; רכב [cognate]	Storm-god riding the winds.
U r. 7′	*rādu*	זרם	7:12 וַיְהִי הַגֶּשֶׁם	[equivalent]	
U r. 12′	*rukub ilāni*	רכוב האלים	Ps 104:3 רְכוּבוֹ; 16–9:13	[cognate] (Ps) / [absent]	Cloud as divine chariot.
U r. 14′	*miḫra ušardi*	את [הגליש] הסכר	7:11 מַעְיְנֹת תְּהוֹם	[equivalent]	
U r. 16′	*Anzû … šamê ušarriṭ*	אנזו … את השמים [קרע]	7:11 אֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמַיִם נִפְתָּחוּ	[equivalent]/[absent]	
U r. 20′	*[iptalaḫ] Anu rigim abūbi*	ירא אנו את שאון המבול	—	[absent]	The gods fear the flood.
z v 4′–8′	*kūm taškunu abūba … Erra, sunqu, nēšu u barbaru*	במקום אשר חוללת מבול …	8:21; 9:2	[divergence]	"Smaller" punishments instead of a flood.

Line	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	Comment
z v 11′–12′	*bēl šērti emid šēressu*	על בעל העונש – הטל את עונשו	9:5–6	[equivalent]	Individual accountability (Wasserman; Ezek 14).
z v 13′–14′	***ištu ūmim-ma ay iššakun abūbu / u nišū lū darâ ana dāriš***	**מן היום – אל יחולל מבול! / והאנשים יהיו קיימים לעד**	**9:11, 15; 8:21–22**	**[equivalent]**	**The only Akkadian "no more flood".** Said by Ea to Enlil, not as covenant.
z v 15′–16′	*īlâm-ma Enlil … ultēlanni ultu libbi eleppi*	עלה אנליל … העלה אותי מתוך הספינה	8:15–16	[divergence]	God takes him out vs. orders him out.
z v 17′	***Zisudra lū Ūt-napištim šumka***	**אתה – זיוסודרה יהי אותנפישתי שמך**	**17:5**	**[equivalent]**	Name change as divine favour (Wasserman).
z v 18′	*tādirti libbi lā īšû*	קדרות לב לא ידעו	5:29 וּמַעֲצַבוֹן יָדֵינוּ	[divergence]	
z v 21′	*ilput pūta u pūssa*	נגע במצח ובמצחה	9:1	[equivalent]	Blessing by touch.

Synoptic table of the key motifs

Sources: Atra-ḫasīs OB III = `../1-אתרחסיס/annotated-III.rtl.md` (SEAL 1517); Gilg. XI = `../2-…/translation.rtl.md`; Sumerian = `../3-…/project.md`, `translation.rtl.md`; Berossus/Abydenus = `../5-…/project.md`, `translation.rtl.md`; the rest = this project. "—" = not preserved; "none" = preserved, and the motif is absent. Line numbers in ( ).

A. Before the flood

Version (date)	Warning: to whom, how	Boat: shape, size, material	Bitumen	Animals	Who shuts the door
Genesis 6–7	God speaks to Noah directly (6:13); no dream	תֵּבָה of gopher wood, 300×50×30 cubits, rooms (קִנִּים), a צֹהַר, side door, 3 decks (6:14–16)	כֹּפֶר **inside and out** (6:14)	**two of every kind**, male and female (6:19–20); 7 pairs of clean animals and birds (7:2–3); they **come to Noah "two by two"** (7:9, 15)	**YHWH shut him in** (7:16)
Sumerian (Ziusudra) (OB mss)	to a **wall**, overheard by Ziusudra (C 17–21); "not a dream"? (C 15, crux)	"huge boat" (D 5); dimensions lost	—	lost in the gap; "small creatures" come down after (E 3)	—
Atra-ḫasīs C_0 (early OB, Larsa)	Ea speaks to Atra-ḫasīs directly, after he **kneels and weeps** (iv 8′–19′); "no dream" (George)	—	—	—	—
Atra-ḫasīs OB III (Sippar, c. 1635)	Atra-ḫasīs asks the meaning of **a dream**; Enki speaks to the **reed fence and wall** (i 13–21)	a **circle(?)** (i 28); roofed **like the Apsû**, "let Šamaš not see inside", roofed above and below (i 29–31)	"let the כֹּפֶר be strong" (i 33); bitumen brought, he seals his door (ii 51)	he **chose and brought in** birds of heaven, cattle, "הַנָּע of the field" (*nammaššû*), craftsmen (ii 34–38); no numbers	**Atra-ḫasīs** seals his door with bitumen (ii 51–52)
Ark Tablet (late OB / early MB)	the god (Ea) to the **wall and reed fence** (1); no dream mentioned	**round** (*kippatu*), base 1 *ikû* (c. 3,600 m²), walls 1 *nindanu* (c. 6 m); **rope**-built, 30 ribs, 3,600 stanchions, cabins above and below (7–17)	חֵמָר **for her outsides and for her inside** (60 kors each), and on the cabins; כֹּפֶר melted in kilns (18–32)	animals of the steppe enter **"two by two"** (*šanā*) (51–52); fodder listed (53–57)	the hero orders: "**Seal** the opening of her door!" (60)

Version (date)	Warning: to whom, how	Boat: shape, size, material	Bitumen	Animals	Who shuts the door
Nippur J (MB)	the god (Ea) to the hero; *apaššar* "I will interpret" (r. 2′): a dream?	"a big boat" of **reeds**, named **"Life-Keeper"**, with a **strong roof** (r. 6′–9′)	—	"[beasts of the fie]ld, wild animals of the field, **birds of heaven**" (r. 11′)	—
Ugarit I / I_2 (MB)	Ea repeats the gods' words to the reed wall (I 12–14); I_2: Ea "at my side" (eBL: "**in my dream**")	I_2: a copper axe → a **wooden** boat (I_2 3–9)	—	—	—
Ḫattuša J_1 (MB)	Atra-ḫasīs and the elders; Ea speaks (4′–10′)	—	"kilns" (7′)	—	—
Nineveh W / BM 38917 (NA, NB)	Ea to Atra-ḫasīs (direct); Ea **draws the plan on the ground** (W 13′–16′)	"**like a circle**" (W 2′); roof strong above and below (W 3′); "to six, to seven, to eight" (BM 38917 rev. 7′–9′); "Life-Keeper" (rev. 12′)	"seal the boat" (W 4′); W 3′ may be "[the כֹּפֶר] strong above and below"	herds and wild animals, herbivores; **Ea sends them to the hero; they wait at his door** (W 9′–10′)	Ea orders the hero: "enter and **close the door**" (W 6′)
Nineveh U (NA)	Ea to the **reed fence** (U 13–16), after the hero hears his footsteps and kneels	—	"he entered and **sealed** the boat" (r. 3′)	—	the hero (r. 3′)
Gilgameš XI (SB)	Ea to the **reed fence and wall** (21–22); "I showed Atra-ḫasīs **a dream**" (197)	1 *ikû* area, walls 10 rods high, top equal: a cube (or round?); 6 decks, 7 levels, 9 sections (57–63)	3 *šār* כֹּפֶר into the kiln, 3 *šār* חֵמָר "inside", oil (66–70)	"seed of all living creatures", beasts and wild animals of the field, craftsmen (27, 84–86); no numbers	Ūta-napišti seals his door; the boatman Puzur-Enlil is "the sealer" (94–95)

Version (date)	Warning: to whom, how	Boat: shape, size, material	Bitumen	Animals	Who shuts the door
Berossus / Abydenus (Greek, c. 290 BCE)	Kronos (= Ea) stands over Xisouthros **in his sleep** (B7.2.1)	5 stadia × 2 stadia (B7.3.2)	none at building; later, people scrape **asphalt** (כֹּפֶר) off the boat as amulets (B7.7.2)	"winged and four-footed" (B7.2.6); no numbers	—

B. The flood and after

Version	Date	Duration	Window / opening	Birds	Landing	Sacrifice; the gods' reaction	The survivor's fate
Genesis	17/II of Noah's 600th year (7:11); 1/X, 1/I (8:5, 13)	40 days rain, 150 days of water, about a year	צֹהַר (6:16); Noah opens חַלּוֹן הַתֵּבָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה (8:6)	**raven**, then **dove** three times (olive leaf) (8:7–12)	mountains of Ararat (8:4)	altar, burnt offerings of clean animals; YHWH smells the רֵיחַ הַנִּיחֹחַ, promises no more curse (8:20–22)	blessing, covenant, rainbow; **no more flood** (9:11); Noah dies at 950 (9:29)
Sumerian	—	**7 days, 7 nights** (D 3)	Ziusudra drills an opening; Utu's light enters (D 6–8)	—	—	ox and sheep slaughtered; prostration (D 9–11)	**eternal life "like a god"**, settled in **Dilmun** (E 7–11)
Atra-ḫasīs C_o	**"day of the moon"** (iv 6′)	—	—	—	—	—	—
Atra-ḫasīs OB III	"[the] month reached [its end]" (ii 39); 7 nights announced by water-clock (i 36–37)	**7 days, 7 nights** (iv 24)	— (gap)	— (gap)	— (gap)	to the four winds; the gods **smell the scent**, gather **like flies**; Nintu's lapis flies; Enlil's anger; Enki: "punish the sinner" (v 30–vi 26)	— (gap); a new order: death, barren women, infant death, celibate priestesses (vi 47–vii 9)
Ark Tablet	"the **dimming day**" (50)	—	—	—	—	(slaughter at the feast, 43)	promised: "**you will live forever**" (3)

Version	Date	Duration	Window / opening	Birds	Landing	Sacrifice; the gods' reaction	The survivor's fate
Ugarit I_2	**"at the beginning of the month"** – the date of the window (1)	—	Ea orders: "**make a window at the top**"; hero cuts it with an axe (4–10)	**dove** (returns exhausted), then ***kumû*** (crane?) (11–14); **ordered by Ea**	—	—	I r. 4′: "life like the gods"
Nineveh U	at dawn (r. 12′)	—	—	—	—	—	—
LB z	—	—	—	—	—	Ea's rebuke: "instead of a flood …"; "punish the sinner"; "**from this day let no flood be brought about**" (v 2′–14′)	Enlil takes him out; **renamed** Ziusudra → Ūta-napišti; "you have become (like the gods), with the gods – life"; blessed with his wife between Anu–Antu, Enlil–Ninlil (v 15′–23′)
Gilgameš XI	Šamaš sets the time (87)	**6 days, 7 nights** (128); boat held 7 days on Mt Nimuš (142–147)	he opens a vent; daylight falls on his cheek (137)	**dove, swallow, raven** (148–156)	**Mount Nimuš** (142)	to the four winds, on the mountain; 7+7 vessels; the gods **smell the sweet scent**, gather like flies (157–163)	he and his wife **become like gods**, live "far away, at the mouth of the rivers" (203–206)

Version	Date	Duration	Window / opening	Birds	Landing	Sacrifice; the gods' reaction	The survivor's fate
Berossus / Abydenus	**15 Daisios** (B7.2.2)	Abydenus: the god's rain abates "on the third day" (Ab1.22)	Xisouthros unstitches part of the boat (B7.4.8)	unnamed **birds**, three times: return; return with **muddy feet**; do not return (B7.4.2–6)	a mountain in **Armenia**, the Korduaian mountains (B7.4.9; 7.7.1)	altar, sacrifice to the gods (B7.4.12)	**vanishes, goes to live with the gods**, with wife, daughter and pilot (B7.4.13; 7.5.5)

Observations for the commentary:

1. **Inside and out** (6:14 ,מִבַּיִת וּמִחוּץ) and **two by two** (15 ,7:9 ,שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם) are attested in Mesopotamia **only in the Ark Tablet** (18–19, 52); the god **sending the animals** to the hero (6:20 ,יָבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ) **only in W 10′**; a **window made and then a bird sent** (8:6–8) **only in I_2** (and, less closely, Gilg. XI 137); **"no more flood"** (9:11) **only in z v 13′**. Each of Genesis's "unique" details has a parallel in one minor recension, never in Gilg. XI.
2. **Who shuts the door**: the hero in every Mesopotamian version where it survives (OB III, Ark, W, U, Gilg. XI); in Genesis, God.
3. **The boat's shape**: round in OB III(?), Ark and W; a cube (or circle) in Gilg. XI; a long ship in Berossus (5×2) and Genesis (6×1).
4. **The date**: the Mesopotamian versions tie the flood to the moon's disappearance (C_0, OB III, Ark, I_2, W); Genesis and Berossus give a calendar date.
5. **The warning**: a dream in OB III, Gilg. XI, Berossus (and possibly J, I_2); a wall in OB III, Ark, I, U, Gilg. XI, Sumerian; direct speech in C_0 and W (and Genesis).

Proposals for the shared renderings

Akkadian	Proposed Hebrew	Reason	Lines
nammaššû / *nammaštû*	הַנָּע (not רָמָשׁ)	**Accepted and applied in the harmonization pass** (both Atr. III ii 37 and Ark 51 now read הַנָּע). Original argument: Atr. III ii 37 chose רָמָשׁ, and I followed it in Ark 51 for consistency, **under protest**: the words are not cognate, and רָמָשׁ creates a Genesis echo exactly where the Ark Tablet is compared with 7:8–9 (וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר רֹמֵשׂ … שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם). הַנָּע ("what moves") is literal (*namāšu* "move"). If changed, change both.	Atr. III ii 37; Ark 51
eṣēru, *uṣurtu*	צוּרָה , צָר (Atr. I) for the whole corpus	**Accepted and applied** (Gilg. XI 60 now צַרְתִּי). Gilg. XI 60 had שִׁרְטֵט; Atr. I and this project use the cognate root (יצר/צור). The plan of the boat (Ark 6–7, W 14–16, Gilg. XI 60) should read alike.	Gilg. XI 60
šapāku vs. *tabāku*	שָׁפַךְ for *šapāku* only [cognate]; *tabāku* → e.g. יָצַק	**Accepted and applied** (Gilg. XI 66, 160 now יצקתי). Gilg. XI 66, 160 used שָׁפַךְ for *tabāku*; the Ark Tablet has the real cognate *šapāku* (20, 22).	Gilg. XI 66, 160; Ark 20, 22
šikaru vs. *sīrāšu*	שֵׂכָר for *šikaru* only [cognate]	**Accepted and applied** (Gilg. XI 73 now סֹבֶא). Gilg. XI 73 used שֵׂכָר for *sīrāšu*.	Gilg. XI 73; Ark 53
kūm vs. *ammaku*	בְּמָקוֹם אֲשֶׁר vs. תַּחַת אֲשֶׁר	Gilg. XI's table proposed תחת אשר for both; different words should differ.	z v 4′–8′; Gilg. XI 188–194
sunqu vs. *ḫušaḫḫu*	כָּפָן vs. רָעָב	Same reason.	z v 6′; Gilg. XI 193
qâlu	הָאֲזִין	Keep apart from *ḫasāsu*/*šitammû* (הקשיב) and *naʾādu* (שִׂם לב).	Ark 2; I 15; I₂ 7
naṣāru	נָצַר (Atr. II) corpus-wide; *nāṣirat napištim* = נוֹצֶרֶת נָפֶשׁ	**Accepted and applied** (Atr. III i 24 note now נוֹצֶרֶת נָפֶשׁ; vi 19, viii 17 נצר). Atr. III i 24 note called it "שומרת הנפש".	J r. 8′; BM 38917 rev. 12′; W 5′, 10′
pītu	מִפְתָּח	Keeps the root פתח (*petû*) apart from *bābu* פֶּתַח.	Ark 60
kīdu, *kīdātu* / *qerbu*	קֶרֶב / חוּצוֹת , חוּץ	For "inside and out": *qerbu* is cognate of קֶרֶב, so בַּיִת is not borrowed.	Ark 18–19, 32
šanā	שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם [cognate]	Hebrew expresses the distributive by repetition; not a borrowed echo.	Ark 52
ṣulūlu / *ṣullulu*	קֹרָה / קֶרֶה	One root, as in Akkadian; extends Gilg. XI 31.	J r. 9′; W 3′

Akkadian	Proposed Hebrew	Reason	Lines
rēš arḫi	רֹאשׁ הַיָּרֵחַ	*warḫu* = ירח [cognate], as Atr. II's יוֹם הַיֶּרַח.	I_2 1
upud / ubut (Atr. III i 22)	keep הרוס, but print Wasserman's היפרד מבית in a note in every version	The Ark Tablet (4) has the same signs; both projects now note it.	Ark 4
Spelling of הרוס	The shared table has הָרֹס; Atr. III writes plene הרוס (unvocalized). I followed Atr. III.	Plene spelling in unvocalized text.	Ark 4

Lessons for the guidelines

- **Translate the minor recensions together with the main texts.** Five of Genesis's "unique" flood details (inside and out; two by two; animals sent to the hero; a window made and then a bird sent; no more flood) are each attested in only one small tablet (Ark, W, I_2, z). A comparison that uses Gilg. XI alone misses them.
- **eBL corpus chapters can quietly re-collate a line.** I_2 2 *ina šuttīya* "in my dream" (eBL, NABU 2008/70) is not in Wasserman 2020, and it changes a motif. Always compare the base edition with the eBL chapter of the same manuscript.
- **The eBL Fragmentarium has unpublished identifications** (BM 38917: a late duplicate of W with new lines). Search it by genre before declaring a corpus complete (`api/fragments/query?genre=…`).
- **Shared-line coordination across parallel sessions:** draft with your own Hebrew, keep a list of every line that touches another project, and re-sync at the end by exact string comparison. Lemma-level consistency (not only identical lines) matters too: Atr. III and the Ark Tablet both have *nammaššû*.
- The Bible-quote checker normalizes `־` but **not the hyphen-minus** that the Psalms/Proverbs files use for maqaf: quotations from those books must keep the `-`.